

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Saving Water in the Driest Place on Earth

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 18

No.	Sentence
1	Growing food is becoming harder as climate change increases _____.
2	Farming uses _____ of the world's fresh water supply.
3	During a severe drought, date farmers have had to draw water from _____.
4	Gaps in sandy soil cause rapid _____ of water.
5	This makes it hard for a plant to establish its _____.
6	Clay has _____ that stick together, helping the soil retain water.
7	According to the maker, the treatment creates a habitat in which _____ can develop.
8	By changing the soil, the clay-and-water mixture promotes _____ in trees.
9	Its maker expects most farmers to recover their _____ within two years.
10	According to its maker, the mixture contains clay, air and water, with _____.

11 **Why is improving water use in farming presented as an important issue?**

- A Farming has made river water permanently unusable.
- B Date farms produce less food than other farms.
- C Farming uses much fresh water while droughts threaten food growing.
- D Household drinking water is the main source of irrigation.

12 **What makes the drought in Yuma especially severe in the account?**

- A It is described as the area's worst in five centuries.
- B It has already forced all date farms to close.
- C It has spread from Yuma across every US state.
- D It has stopped rivers from carrying any water.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What effect do the liquid's makers claim for sandy desert soil?**
- A It supplies all the nutrients plants need to make.
 - B It removes the need for a plant's root system.
 - C It changes the weather immediately around farms.
 - D It helps the ground hold water and nutrients.
- 14 **Why is the habitat for soil microbiology significant in the maker's explanation?**
- A It prevents all future changes to the soil.
 - B It may help soil life and natural processes develop.
 - C It replaces the need for any water in the soil.
 - D It proves the mixture works in every desert.
- 15 **What financial tradeoff is described for farmers considering the technique?**
- A A low setup price comes with high annual fees.
 - B An immediate profit comes with a shorter harvest.
 - C A substantial initial cost may be recovered within two years.
 - D A free trial may lead to permanent equipment costs.
- 16 **What water-saving benefit does the maker claim for fruit trees?**
- A They could need half as much water to grow.
 - B They could grow without any water at all.
 - C They could produce twice as many fruits with no change in water.
 - D They could be protected from half of future droughts.
- 17 **What concern is raised about changing the soil in this way?**
- A The technique has already damaged nearby farms.
 - B Harmful effects might emerge later.
 - C The mixture will stop natural processes immediately.
 - D The soil will become too expensive for other uses.
- 18 **What overall conclusion is best supported by the claimed benefits and the later caution?**
- A The water savings prove it is a permanent solution.
 - B The named ingredients guarantee it is safe over time.
 - C Its initial cost means it cannot help any farmers.
 - D Its long-term value remains uncertain despite the claims.